

Unreal Engine 4.5 updated

Epic games has updated the Unreal Engine to 4.5 bringing in around 40 new features and a tutorial system
<http://dgit.in/UnrealEngineUp>



Goodbye webOS

HP will be shutting down app catalogs and cloud services support for webOS devices in 15 Jan, 2015
<http://dgit.in/EndOfwebOS>



Your social history is a factor during hiring

real clinical disorder. One could argue that spending three hours a day reading random tweets from strangers doesn't necessarily indicate that you're addicted to Twitter. You could merely be news reading to stay updated, right? However, research conducted in 2012 by Chicago University's Booth Business School concluded that Twitter is harder to resist than cigarettes and alcohol. If that isn't a sign of addiction, what is? There has actually been a case of a Korean child starving to death because the parents were too engrossed in games on the internet!

- **Low self-esteem:** All of us look at each other's social network pages, admire lifestyles, relationships and clothes. More often than not, this leads to us wishing our lives were as great as others. People thus often end up feeling miserable about themselves, which can at times even lead to low self-esteem or depression. In fact, a recent German research study concluded that one out of three people felt worse after Facebooking, often due to perceived inadequacies when comparing themselves to friends. Children, especially, are

susceptible to depression and anxiety as they feel they have an image to maintain and cliques to fit into.

- **Loss of Independent thinking:** Speaking of cliques, social media users are often more vulnerable to peer pressure than the average person. People are usually found changing their minds about "liking" certain things (One picture over the other, for instance) if enough time had passed and they found the other side even moderately more popular.
- **Change in spending habits, hunger...:** New study actually suggests that heavy social media use might just be correlated to lower self-control, which according to marketing experts leads to higher spending. Also, the 'food porn' photos that we so often see on Instagram or Facebook can actually activate the brain's reward center and compel viewers to overeat! In fact, even looking at food images after a meal can trigger hunger.

Clearly, being active on social media possibly has negative implications for our mental health, and is pretty scary to imagine. However, the list of ill effects doesn't end here.

Effects on productivity

While many businesses use social networks to find and communicate with clients, the platforms also prove to be a great distraction to employees. Many of us can't go an hour without checking for updates, and this can distract us from the tasks we're hired to do. Studies from 2010 say that productivity decreased by around 2 percent thanks to Facebook, accounting for a loss of around £2.2 billion per year in Britain alone (Source: Nucleus Research and Morse). A later study conducted in 2012 and reported by Mashable puts the loss at \$650 Billion in the US alone. You can see how this trend progresses. While there are establishments willing to embrace the obsession, many other offices

are taking measures to block social networking in their premises. However, these access-blocking technologies are spotty and can usually be bypassed with ease.

How many of your "friends" are real?

Although social networking helps us maintain old relationships and forge new ones, people nowadays are content scrolling through an endless list of bite-sized snippets of personal information, and interacting purely through chat or comments. Social media sites can make it difficult for us to distinguish between meaningful relationships we foster in the



You just picked the blue pill!

real world and the many casual relationships formed through social media. And many people who are friends online are unable to carry out a face-to-face conversation amiably. By focusing so much of our time and energy on these less meaningful relationships, there's a chance that our more important real life connections are being ignored. Also, many of these friends might not even be real people. They could be bots with believable fake profiles or pages – such as a page dedicated to Robin Williams' death as a recent example – which eventually lure unsuspecting people to a phishing site/blog.

Social networking sites have already changed the way we think, experience, interact, make friends etc. But as we've seen, there are many adverse effects to social networking, giving you good reason to stay away from it. However, a complete boycott seems implausible, as social networking is clearly here to stay. Therefore, it's time we reconsider some of our social networking habits before we lose ourselves in this madness. 📱



Social presence is indirectly proportional to privacy